Every morning, my house follows the same routine—one that may have seemed part of a dystopian world a few years ago.

As I wake up, I greet whichever AI assistant is listening in my bedroom—Siri on my watch or Google somewhere in between. The curtains auto-open themselves to the sunlight. In the living room, the Dreame robot detaches from its dock and begins its tour of the house before I've even found my slippers.

The lights brighten from a low, sleep-friendly amber to a level better suited for daytime. In the garage, my car silently sends its battery level to my phone. After the news plays a short summary, calming music takes over the speakers. The room adjusts itself to the temperature I prefer for that hour. By the time I get to the kitchen, the coffee machine has already started brewing my cuppa joe, while the Dyson Air Purifier has been gently running since sunrise.

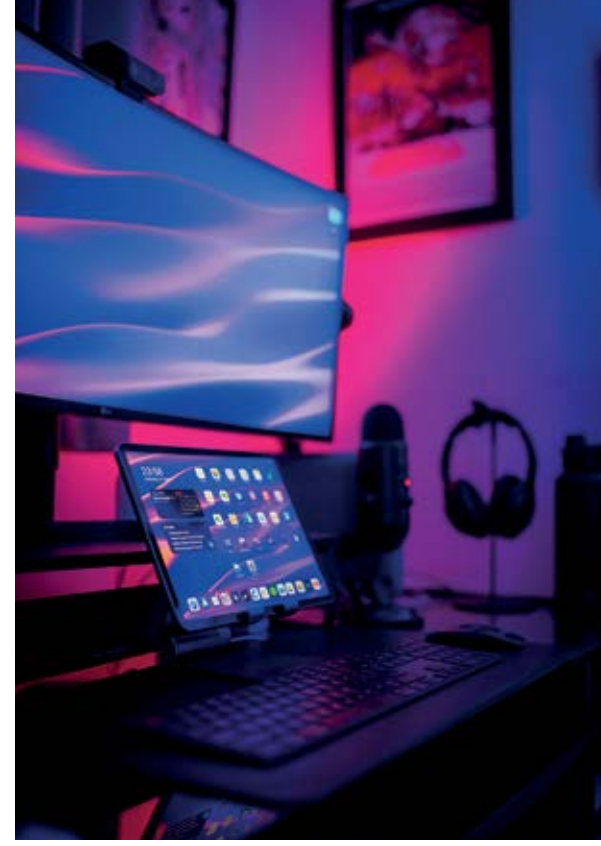
All of this might sound like a staged demonstration, but it's my living reality; an ordinary Tuesday. This is how I've set up my home for years, and it gets a tad smarter every season. It's the closest I've got to being Tony Stark without the suit. Although no comparison to Jarvis, it's a house that listens, remembers, and takes action without being asked twice.

The advent of such devices not having to wait for commands has made a world of difference. For years, a "smart home" simply meant accessing devices through a number of apps—one for the lights, one for the locks, one for the thermostat, and the like. Each smart on its own but with little to no knowledge of the world around them.

Enter AI home orchestration. Primarily spotted in the luxury interiors market, it's an intelligence layer that coordinates smart home systems like lighting, climate, security, and audio into one unifying system, enabling one "smart conversation" rather than 20 separate ones.

"Home automation has evolved from a luxury add-on into an essential design priority, and the focus has moved from adding gadgets to making homes feel effortless," says Joaquim C Rodrigues, Principal Architect at the Delhi-based Purple Studio. "Modern setups seamlessly integrate climate, media, security, and mood lighting into a single interface. The industry has shifted towards human-centric designs and smart-assistant integration, with interfaces intuitive enough for an 80-year-old or a 7-year-old."

A number of firms like Savant were founded specifically for this purpose—not to introduce yet



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Clockwise from facing page: The Philips Hue Light Theatre arrangement syncs the ambient colours with what's on the screen; smart apps and devices can now quietly coordinate features like the ambient lighting and even control over the blinds